Low-Code Experiment

Setting up a Zoho Creator Account and Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

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Abstract

This experiment covers the first steps of working with Zoho Creator, a low-code application platform. It records access to the Zoho Creator account, the application creation screen for Patient Appointment Scheduling System, and an exploration of the platform interface and architecture. The experiment describes the main building blocks of the platform, namely forms, reports, pages, workflows, Deluge scripting, integrations, and the Development, Stage, and Production environments. The application will be extended in the later experiments of this lab.

1. Aim

To access Zoho Creator, create the Patient Appointment Scheduling System application, and explore the platform architecture and user interface.

2. Introduction

Zoho Creator is a cloud-based low-code platform that lets users build custom business applications through a visual interface. Forms, reports, dashboards, and pages are assembled using visual builders, and business logic is added through workflows and a scripting language called Deluge. Because hosting, database, and deployment capabilities are provided by the platform, an application can be developed and shared without managing servers.

In this lab, Zoho Creator is used to develop a Patient Appointment Scheduling System that organizes patient details, doctor information, appointment requests, and scheduling reports. The application is intended to support appointment entry and help clinic staff review scheduling information. This experiment prepares the ground for later form design, reports, workflows, and dashboard development.

3. Requirements

• A computer with an internet connection and a modern web browser.
• A Zoho account with access to Zoho Creator.

4. Procedure

Step 1: Sign in to Zoho Creator. Open Zoho Creator and sign in with the account. The home screen displays the left navigation menu and the profile panel. Clicking the profile icon at the top right opens account information and options such as My Account, Help, API Doc, Mobile Apps, and Sign Out (Figure 1).

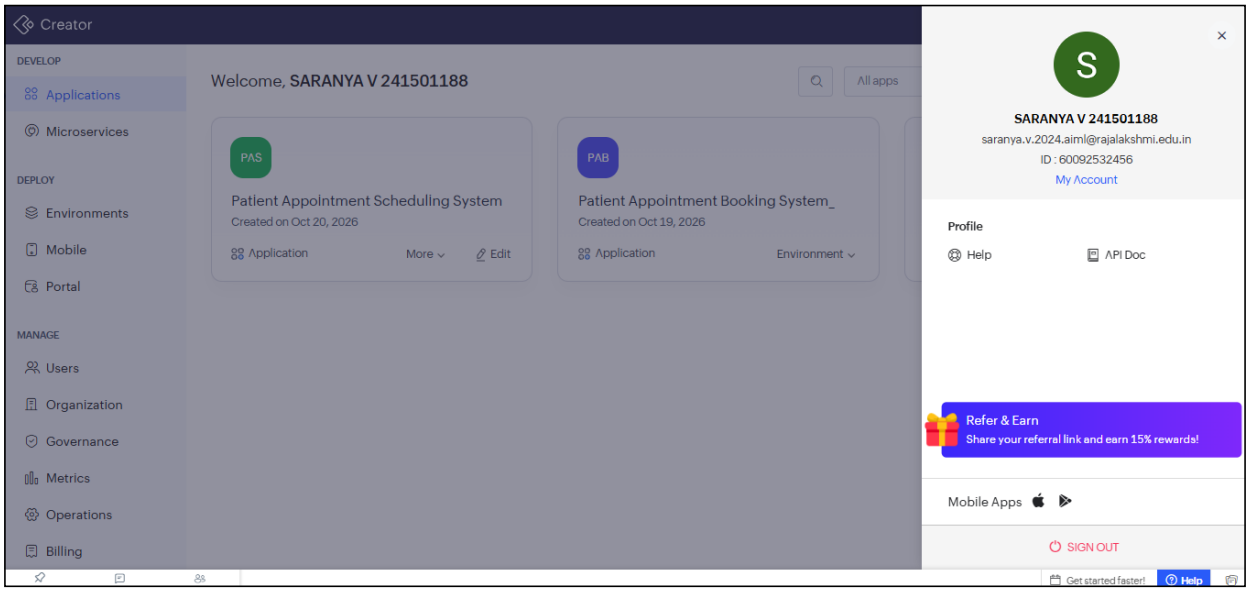


Figure 1: Zoho Creator home screen with the profile panel open

Step 2: Start creating an application. On the home screen, click *Create Application* and select *Create from scratch*.

Step 3: Enter the application name. Enter *Patient Appointment Scheduling System* in the application-name field. The supplied screenshot shows the *Enable Environment* option unchecked; therefore, environment enablement should be verified separately if it is required for later deployment (Figure 2).

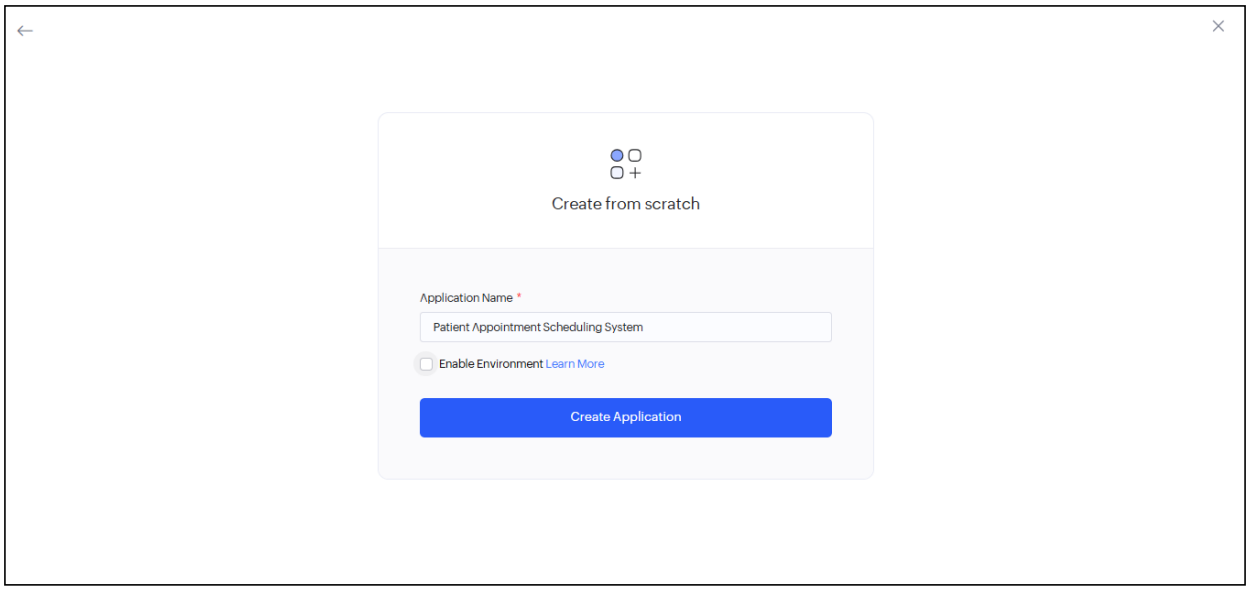


Figure 2: Create-from-scratch screen with the project application name

Step 4: Explore the application builder. The builder provides the design area and options for forms, workflows, and settings. The supplied HOTEL BOOKING screenshot is retained only to illustrate the general builder interface; it is not evidence of the project application itself (Figure 3).

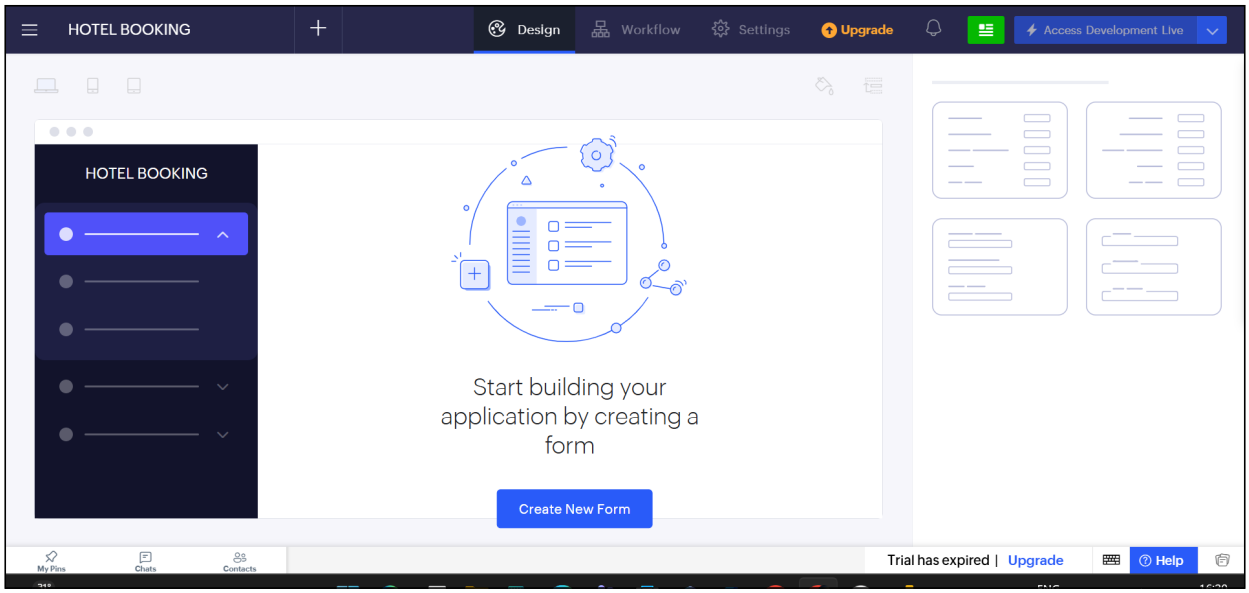


Figure 3: Reference image of the Zoho Creator application-builder layout

Step 5: Check the application in the Applications list. Return to the home screen. The supplied screenshot shows Patient Appointment Scheduling System as an application card, alongside the separate Patient Appointment Booking System application (Figure 4).

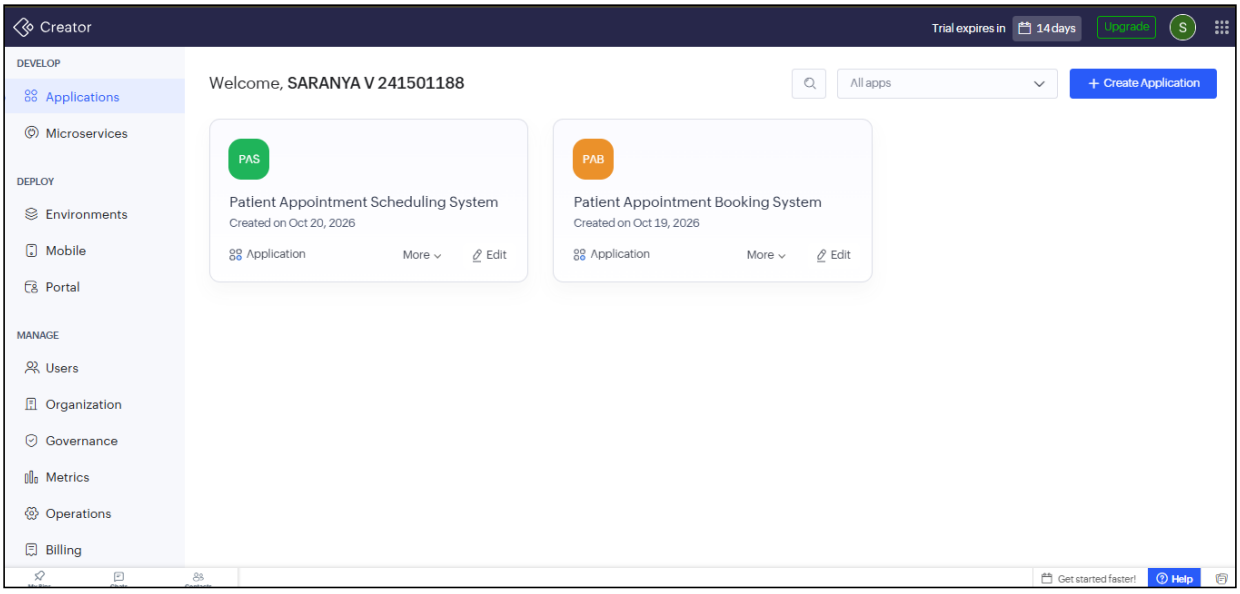


Figure 4: Applications list showing Patient Appointment Scheduling System

Step 6: Explore the Environments section. Select *Environments* from the left navigation under Deploy. The page separates Stage and Production. The supplied screenshot shows no applications added to these environments, so deployment to either environment is not claimed (Figure 5).

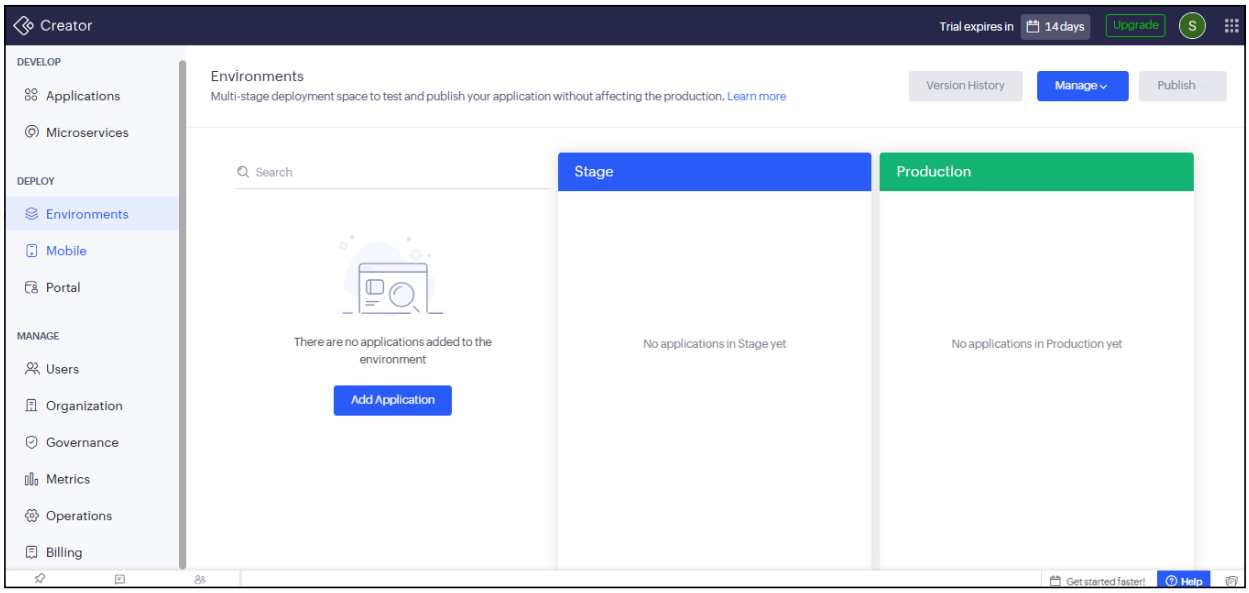


Figure 5: Environments page showing the Stage and Production spaces

5. Platform Architecture

The Zoho Creator application can be described using four main layers. The presentation layer contains the forms, reports, pages, and dashboards used by staff. The logic layer contains workflows, Deluge scripts, schedules, and approvals. The data layer stores patient, doctor, and appointment records. The integration layer connects the application to other Zoho services and external systems through authorized connections and APIs. Development, Stage, and Production provide a deployment path, while user and governance settings support administration.

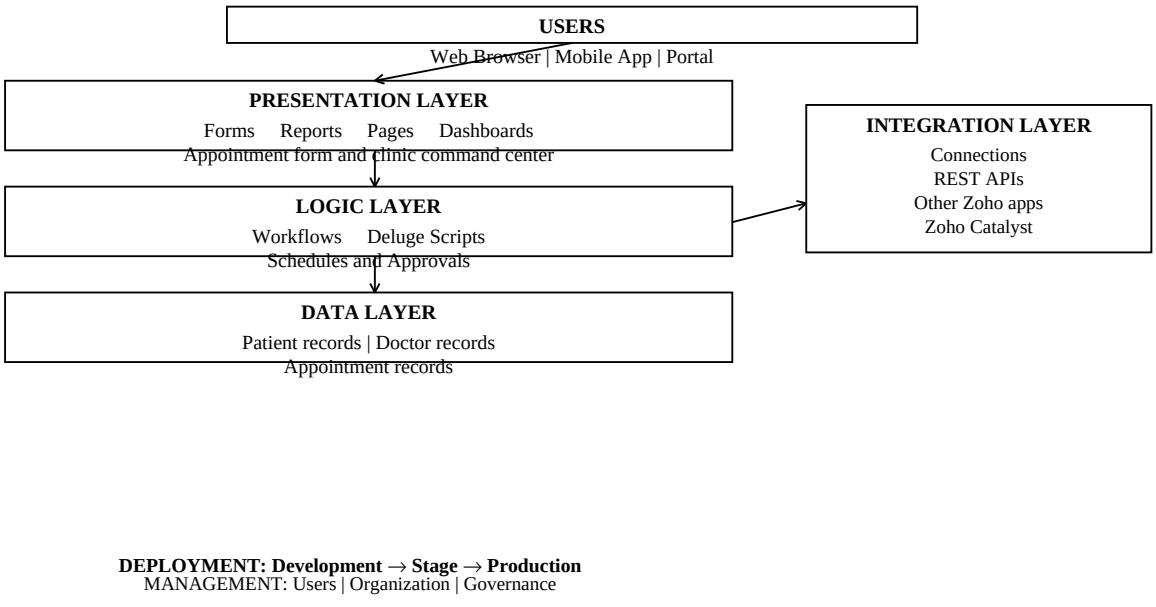


Figure 6: Layered architecture of the Patient Appointment Scheduling System

Component

Component	Description	Role in the Patient Appointment Scheduling System
Forms	Data-entry screens built from field types such as Name, Email, Date, and Dropdown.	Appointment_Booking_Form captures patient and appointment details.
Reports	Views of stored records with filters and sorting.	Appointment reports help clinic staff review scheduling requests.
Pages	Custom pages and dashboards built with Page Builder.	The clinic command center can summarize appointments and provide quick actions.
Workflows	Actions triggered when records are created, edited, or on a schedule.	Can support appointment confirmation, reminders, and status updates when configured.
Deluge	Scripting language for custom business logic.	Can support validation and appointment-processing rules.
Connections and APIs	Links to other Zoho services and external systems.	Can support authorized notifications and integration.
Environments	Development, Stage, and Production deployment spaces.	Supports testing before publishing when configured.
Users and Governance	User accounts, roles, and administration controls.	Can separate administrator, doctor, and receptionist access.

6. Interface Exploration

Area	Items Observed	Purpose
Left menu: Develop	Applications, Microservices	Build and manage applications and microservices.
Left menu: Deploy	Environments, Mobile, Portal	Manage deployment stages and mobile or portal access.
Left menu: Manage	Users, Organization, Governance, Metrics, Operations, Billing	Administer users, organization settings, and policies.
Application builder	Design, Workflow, Settings, Access Development Live	Design the application, configure logic, and run it.
Applications list	Application cards with names and Edit/More actions	Open and manage applications.

7. Observations

• The Zoho Creator home screen provides access to application development, deployment, and management areas.
• The application-name field was filled with Patient Appointment Scheduling System.
• The Applications list shows the Patient Appointment Scheduling System card and a separate Patient Appointment Booking System card.
• The Environments screen shows no applications added to Stage or Production.
• The builder separates design, workflow, and settings, while forms are the starting point for data collection.

8. Result

The Zoho Creator interface was explored, and Patient Appointment Scheduling System was confirmed to be visible in the Applications list. The application creation screen and Environments page were examined. The platform's main components and layered architecture were documented. The application is ready for subsequent experiments involving form design, reports, dashboards, and workflows.

9. Conclusion

Zoho Creator provides a low-code environment for developing applications through visual design tools, data forms, reports, workflows, and integration features. Understanding the interface and architecture establishes a foundation for implementing the Patient Appointment Scheduling System in later experiments.

10. Summary

This experiment documented the initial setup of the Patient Appointment Scheduling System in Zoho Creator. It examined the account panel, application creation screen, Applications list, and Environments page, and described the platform in terms of presentation, logic, data, and integration layers with a Development-to-Production deployment path.